Administrator

You own the deployment. This chapter is what only you can do, and the four things that will hurt if you do them carelessly.

> Read `00-orientation.md` first. You hold every permission in the system, including any added by a future release — so every other chapter in this manual also describes something you can do.

Settings

Settings sits apart from the operations navigation and has its own shell. The reason is stated in the product: *nothing here moves a shipment.* These screens configure the operator — who may sign in, what a branch invoices as, what the product is called.

SCREEN	WHAT IT IS FOR
Users & roles	Who can sign in, and what they hold in each branch
Branches	Currency, invoice series, working calendar, trading conditions, chart of accounts, per entity
Audit log	Every write, by whom, from where
Vendor access	What your supplier's support can see, and for how long
Notification wording	What the product says when it writes to somebody — shared with the operations manager, see `02-operations-manager.md`
API keys	Read-only keys a customer's systems pull their shipments with, and the webhooks that push events to them
Mailboxes	The addresses the system reads for incoming enquiries, per branch
Integrations	The relay that sends the mail, the carrier registrations, the file store, the model key, and the provider that will transmit invoices
Brand	Colours, name and mark, and the variable behind each

They appear in that order, and `/settings` opens on the first one your role can see.

Reference data deliberately stayed in operations. Ports, charge types, milestone templates and exception codes are daily operational work, and putting them behind an administrative wall is how a system grows a free-text "Other" field that swallows the data it was meant to structure. Your operations manager owns them — see `02-operations-manager.md`.

Users and roles

Adding someone

The product is invitation-only. There is no sign-up form, so there is nothing to bootstrap from and nothing for a stranger to find.

Settings → Users & roles lists everyone: name, email, their branch and role badges, whether they have a sign-in, when they were last seen, and whether they are active. **Invite someone** creates a person — both names, email, phone, language, role, and the branches they work in, ticked one by one. You can only grant branches you hold yourself; `admin.users.write` in one branch is not a route to every branch.

The dialog deliberately has no password field, and it does not create a sign-in. An administrator who can type a colleague's password can sign in as them, and the audit log would say it was the colleague. The credential is created from a shell on the server, against the same email, and the two rows are linked:

```
pnpm db:create-user --email ops@yourcompany.com --name "Operations" \
                    --role operations_manager
```

That writes, in one transaction, the four rows an account needs: the auth user, the hashed credential, the domain principal, and **a role per branch**. Without the branch role the account signs in and sees nothing — which is the most common way a new user's first day goes wrong.

By default it grants the role in every active branch. To scope it to one:

```
pnpm db:create-user --email kwi@yourcompany.com --name "Kuwait Desk" \
                    --role coordinator --branch KWI
```

The generated password prints once. Give it to the person directly. Do not email it.

Suspending someone

Suspend, on their row. It takes their access away on their next request; everything they wrote stays exactly as it is, and their name keeps appearing on the records they created. Nothing is deleted — the account stays on the list, marked inactive, and **Restore** gives it back with the same branches and roles.

Resetting a password

Two paths. **Forgotten your password?** on the sign-in page sends the person a link that expires in an hour — it needs *Outbound mail* configured under **Settings → Integrations**, and a deployment without it logs the failure rather than appearing to work. Or re-run `db:create-user` for the existing email: it resets that password and changes nothing else, and it is the path when mail is not yet configured.

Roles are per branch

The same person can be a **coordinator in Kuwait and read-only in Dubai**. That is the intended shape, not a workaround — a person who covers another office during a holiday gets read access there and keeps their own role at home.

Every screen counts and shows only the branches a person holds a role in. There is no "all branches" toggle, and there should not be.

Two-factor

Administrator and Finance must enrol. They are the two roles that can change who has access and can issue money documents. Nobody can opt out, including you. The requirement is a flag on the role, not on the person: the **Roles** table on this screen shows *Two-factor: Required* against those two, with the number of permissions each role holds, and a person's badge carries the same mark.

Choosing a role

Seven roles, described in full in `09-permissions-reference.md`. Three rules of thumb:

Grant the narrowest role that lets someone do their job. The customs broker role exists precisely so that a broker does not need a coordinator's access.

Do not put an operations person in the Finance role because they "help with invoices". The separation between issuing invoices and running operations is the one an auditor asks about first, and it is enforced rather than advised.

Read-only is a real answer. For an owner who wants to look, a new joiner in their first fortnight, or an accountant who needs to see and not touch.

Branches

Each branch carries **its own base currency, its own invoice series and its own working calendar**. **Add branch** and **Edit branch** on **Settings → Branches**:

	WHY IT MATTERS
Code	Short, and it prefixes every reference this branch creates
Currency	What the entity reports and invoices in
Legal name, in both languages	The Arabic one is required — it appears on Arabic invoices
Invoice prefix	Numbering is per branch, and gaps are questions at audit. Voided invoices keep their number for exactly this reason. Defaults to the branch code, and **cannot be changed once invoices have been issued**.
House B/L series	Numbers the house bills the branch issues. Leave blank to number them by hand.
Working calendar	**Every SLA clock and ageing rule counts against this.** Kuwait, Qatar and the UAE share neither a weekend nor a holiday list.
Time zone, **tax registration**	Per entity — `Asia/Kuwait` and `Asia/Dubai` are not the same hour
Trading conditions and **Not included**	Printed at the foot of, and beside the charges on, every quotation this entity issues — in both languages. Each entity trades under its own law; Kuwait and Dubai do not share a footer.
Sends from	Who notifications from this entity come from. Blank uses the deployment's own address.
Quiet hours	No customer notification leaves between these hours, in the branch's local time. Internal alerts are never held.

	WHY IT MATTERS
Chart of accounts	Receivables, payables, bank, output tax, FX variance, rounding — where this entity posts. Leave blank until you have the codes; the accounting export names what is missing.

Load next year's public holidays before January. If you do not, every deadline over the break is wrong, in the same direction, for every branch — and nobody notices until a customer does.

The audit log

Every write, recorded **by the database itself** rather than by the application — so a change that goes around the application is still recorded. When, what operation, which table, who, which branch, which record, from which address.

Nobody can edit or delete an entry. Update and delete are revoked from every role in the system, including yours and including your supplier's. This is not a policy; it is a permission that does not exist.

Read it when a figure is disputed or a change needs attributing. That is what it is for, and it is worth telling your team it exists — not as a threat, but because a team that knows changes are attributable argues less about what happened.

Vendor access — the one to understand properly

Support cannot see your data by default. There is no standing access, no support account with a permanent key, and no back door.

When your supplier needs to look at something, **you grant it**, from **Settings → Vendor access**:

FIELD	WHAT TO PUT
Engineer	The named person. Not a team.
Ticket or reason	e.g. `SUP-1042 — invoice total disputed on KWI-2026-01041`. Recorded against every session opened under the grant.
Expires after	A number of hours. Choose the smallest that is plausible.
Access	Read only, or read and write
Branches	Leave blank for the branches you hold. **Choosing fewer is always safer.**

Read-and-write requires typing `GRANT WRITE` to confirm. The friction is deliberate. Most support work is diagnosis and needs read access only — ask what they intend to change before you grant write, and if the answer is "nothing yet", grant read.

While a grant is live, **a banner sits at the top of every page** of your system saying so, for everyone. Nobody is unaware that an outsider is in.

You can **revoke it in one click**, at any time, without explanation.

Every grant and every session opened under it is recorded permanently, and *that record cannot be edited or deleted by anyone, including your supplier*. So the question "what did they look at" always has an answer.

Habits worth keeping:

- Grant hours, not days
- Grant read unless write has been justified in words you understood
- Grant the branch in question, not all of them
- Revoke when the call ends rather than waiting for expiry
- Read the vendor-access screen once a month even when nothing is open

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Mailboxes

Settings → Mailboxes. The addresses this system reads. Mail arriving in one becomes an enquiry for that branch, or joins the thread of the enquiry or job it quotes by reference. The service checks every connected mailbox once a minute, and a new enquiry is on the board within that.

Connect a mailbox: the branch whose enquiries arrive there, the address, the IMAP server and port, TLS, the password, the folder (usually `INBOX`), and optionally a folder to move handled mail to — leave it blank and mail is marked read where it is. The password is stored encrypted and is never shown again; when editing, leave it blank to keep the one stored.

This is your key, not the operations manager's, and the reason is stated in the matrix: a charge type is a business rule, and this row is the password to a mailbox that in an office this size is usually somebody's whole account.

Each row shows when it was last checked and when mail last arrived. A mailbox marked **Not reading** collects no enquiries — check the password first, because most failures here are a credential that changed. **Stop reading** pauses one without losing anything; **Start reading** resumes, and anything unread that accumulated in the meantime arrives as enquiries.

Before connecting a real mailbox: the deployment needs `MAILBOX_ENCRYPTION_KEY` set, or the form cannot be saved — it says so. And you hold no branch you cannot connect a mailbox for; an administrator with no branch role is told to get one first.

Integrations

Settings → Integrations. The accounts this deployment reaches the outside world with. A credential saved here takes effect within a minute, with no release, and takes precedence over the deployment's environment variables — **Stop using these settings** falls back to the environment without losing what was typed, which is how a change is rolled back.

Credentials are sealed on the way in and never shown again; leave a field blank to keep the one stored. The first option in each mode list is the one that costs nothing and asks nobody.

GROUP	CARD	WHAT IT DOES
Platform	**Outbound mail**	The relay every notification leaves through. Without it nothing reaches a customer and nobody can be sent a password reset. *Sending*, or *Written to the log, not sent*.
	Object storage	Where every stored document lives — issued bills, invoices, scans. Without it documents render but cannot be kept.

GROUP	CARD	WHAT IT DOES
	Inbound mail webhook	The shared secret a mail provider signs its forwarding webhook with. Separate from the mailboxes above.
Carriers	**Container tracking**	*Typed by an operator*, or *Carrier-direct (free)*. The driver only; the credentials live on the three carrier cards.
	Maersk, **Hapag-Lloyd**, **CMA CGM**	One self-serve registration each, at the carrier's own developer portal. Each card says which carrier codes it covers and what is still needed before it can be switched on.
	Carrier poll budget	How often the poll asks and how many shipments each run covers. The card works out calls per hour, which has to stay under the carrier's cap.
Finance	**Exchange rates**	*Typed by hand*, or *Daily from a feed*. Nothing prices from the feed — a charge line keeps the rate it was struck at.
	E-invoice transmission	The accredited provider that files an invoice with the tax authority. *Not transmitted* until somebody has bought one.
Document extraction	**Document extraction**	The model key. It switches on the assistant, reading enquiries off emails, and reading supplier bills from scans — billed per document, with a monthly ceiling set here. An unread bill is simply one that gets typed.

A card marked **Not working** is one the service could not resolve on its last run; the reason is on the card, and correcting it here takes effect within a minute.

Carrier tracking is built but off until you register. With the driver on *Carrier-direct* and a carrier's credentials entered, container milestones on that carrier's shipments arrive from the carrier's own events. Until then, every milestone is typed — and a WhatsApp Business card on this screen notwithstanding, WhatsApp is not a channel in this release.

API keys

Settings → API keys. Read-only keys a customer's own systems use to pull their shipments, milestones and released documents from the read API, without a login.

Issue a key — a name (*their ERP, their portal…*), the customer it reads for, the branch, and an optional expiry. **The key is shown once and is not stored.** If it is lost, revoke it and issue another. Each row shows when it was last used; **Revoke** ends it, and keys are revoked, never deleted, so *when did it stop working* always has an answer.

Webhooks are the other direction: where the system posts an event the moment it happens, so a customer's system does not have to poll. **Subscribe** with an `https` URL and, optionally, the events wanted — empty means everything. Each delivery is signed with HMAC-SHA256 in `x-qabandi-signature` using a secret shown once at subscription; give it to whoever receives the events, because they verify the signature with it. Each endpoint shows its last delivery and how many are failing, and can be turned off without being removed.

Brand

Settings → Brand shows every colour, name and mark the product resolves at runtime — and the environment variable behind each one.

The whole product is re-skinned by setting variables. No rebuild, no code change:

```
BRAND_NAME_EN="Meridian Logistics" BRAND_MONOGRAM=M \
BRAND_PRIMARY_HUE=155 BRAND_ACCENT_HUE=25 BRAND_RADIUS=4
```

Both themes, every tonal ramp, every semantic colour and the chart series derive from those tokens. The screen renders the resolved values so the claim is inspectable rather than asserted.

Two things deliberately do not follow your brand, and should not be made to:

Status colours. Positive, caution, critical, info and muted are reserved for state. A board where "held" is calm because it matched a corporate palette is worse than useless. If your brand hue lands within about 15° of one of them, it will read as that status — move the brand hue, not the status colour.

Chart series. Four slots, assigned in order and never cycled. All four are validated for lightness, contrast against both surfaces, and separation under the two common forms of colour blindness, in both light and dark themes. Changing one means re-running that validation.

Bulk import

Network → Bulk import. Bringing existing data in from a spreadsheet, checked row by row before anything is written.

What can be imported

	NOTES
Customers	Both names, code, terms
Customer contacts	Attached to customers by code
Agents and hauliers	The partner register
Ports and places	
Rate cards	Buy — an agent tariff, needs the partner — or sell
Open jobs	For a mid-year cutover
Open receivables	For a mid-year cutover

How it works

1. **Choose what to import**, and the branch. Every row is created against that branch.
2. **Download the template** if you want the columns in the right order.
3. **Choose the file.** CSV or tab-separated, saved from Excel. The first row must be the headings.
4. **Check the file.** Columns are matched to your headings automatically; correct anything your agent named differently. Unmatched columns are listed as ignored so nothing is silently dropped.
5. **Read the result.** Rows read, rows accepted, and every problem with its line number. You can download the problem list.
6. **Import**, only if everything passed.

The rule that matters

A file with any errors imports nothing. Not the good rows — nothing.

That is deliberate and it is worth defending when somebody asks for a partial-import option. A half-imported customer list is worse than no import, because nobody can tell which half is in, and the second attempt creates duplicates of the first.

Rate cards will be rejected for overlapping an existing card on the same lane. That is the protection working — two overlapping cards on one lane are unrepresentable in this system, by design. Fix the validity dates on one of them.

Doing a real migration

Order matters, because later files refer to earlier ones:

1. Ports and places
2. Agents and hauliers
3. Customers
4. Customer contacts
5. Rate cards — sell first, then buy per partner
6. Open jobs
7. Open receivables

Import into one branch first and look at the result before running the rest. Ten minutes of checking here saves a day of unpicking, and there is no undo — the correction path is editing records, not re-running the file.

Operating the deployment

If your supplier operates the deployment, this section is theirs. If you operate it yourself, this is the whole of the job.

COMMAND	WHAT IT DOES
`pnpm db:migrate`	Apply schema migrations. Forward-only.
`pnpm db:seed`	Reference rows and the role/permission matrix
`pnpm db:create-user`	Provision an account that can sign in
`pnpm fleet:status`	What schema version each deployment is on, and whether it is reachable
`pnpm fleet:migrate`	Migrate across deployments, sequentially, with a report
`pnpm fleet:backup`	Dump every deployment
`pnpm fleet:restore-drill`	Dump, restore into a scratch database, verify, drop

`fleet:restore-drill` is the one to schedule. A backup nobody has restored is a hypothesis. The drill restores into a scratch database and checks the *content*, not the exit status — including that the security policies survived, because a restore that drops them produces a database that looks perfect and enforces nothing.

Dumps must be taken through the admin connection. The application account cannot read outside its own branches, so a dump taken as the application role is silently partial — the most dangerous artefact in this whole area, because it looks like a backup.

What only you can break

Granting the wrong role. Every other mistake in this manual is recoverable from the audit log. This one is somebody seeing what they should not, and it is not visible until it matters. Grant the narrowest role.

Granting standing vendor write access. Hours, not days. Read, not write, unless justified.

Forgetting the working calendar. Every SLA in the system counts against it. A missing holiday list is every deadline wrong in the same direction, silently.

An unverified backup. Run the restore drill on a schedule. Do not assume the dump is good because the command exited zero.

What is not in this release

A sign-in created from a screen	*Invite someone* creates the person and their branch roles; the credential is still created from a shell, against the same email.
Self-service password reset without mail	*Forgotten your password?* works once *Outbound mail* is configured. Until then, `db:create-user` is the reset path.
Editing the role matrix from the interface	The matrix is seeded and editable without a release, but not from a screen today. The *Roles* table on Users & roles shows it.
WhatsApp notifications	Not in this release. Email is the channel, once *Outbound mail* is configured.
Carrier tracking without registering	The feeds are carrier-direct and need each carrier's own credentials under *Integrations*. Until they are entered, milestones are typed.
Scheduled reports	In delivery. Every screen exports today.